

# Mohamed Baraa Lafi

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## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Incoming PhD candidate in Economics at the Paris School of Economics (PSE), specializing in macroeconomics, political economy, and public economics. Research interests include institutions, economic development, fiscal policy, subsidy reform, and public policy evaluation. Experienced in applied econometrics and causal inference, including regression analysis, fixed effects (FE), instrumental variables (IV), difference-in-differences (DiD), regression discontinuity designs (RDD), synthetic control methods, and randomized controlled trials (RCTs). Proficient in Python and R.

## EDUCATION

- Paris School of Economics** Sept. 2025 – Present  
*M.Sc. in Analysis and Policy in Economics (APE)* Paris, France
- University Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne** Sept. 2022 – June 2025  
*B.Sc. in Economics, Minor in Computer Science — Thesis grade: 18/20* Paris, France
- Médenine High School** 2022  
*Mathematics Baccalauréat — GPA: 18.60/20 — National Rank: 91<sup>st</sup>/6,482* Médenine, Tunisia

## PUBLICATIONS

- Public Enterprises in Tunisia** July 2026  
*Empirical analysis of public enterprise performance and governance — published in English and Arabic*
- Replication of Forbes & Warnock (2012)** May 2026  
*Independent replication study on capital flow episodes (sudden stops, surges, retrenchments and flights)*
- What Would Saudi Arabia Look Like Without Vision 2030?** March 2026  
*Early Evidence from Synthetic Controls — doi:10.5281/zenodo.19210741*
  - Applies the Synthetic Control Method to causally evaluate Saudi Arabia’s Vision 2030 across four dimensions: female labor force participation, FDI inflows, international tourism, and services employment.
  - Results validated through placebo-in-space tests and permutation inference across a donor pool of structurally comparable resource-dependent economies.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Université Paris 2 Panthéon-Assas** Sept. 2026 – Present  
*Chargé de TD (Teaching Assistant) — Microeconomics 2 (Production)* Paris, France
  - Leading tutorial sessions in microeconomics (production theory) for undergraduate students.
- CY Cergy Paris Université** Jun. 2026 – Aug. 2026  
*Research Assistant (Internship)* Paris, France
  - Research Assistant under the supervision of (Mrs. Pamela Bombarda). Conducting research on the effects of robotization on informality and labor markets.
- Hôtel Antin Saint-Georges** (prev.: Hôtel Régence, Staffmatch) Mar. 2023 – Present  
*Night Auditor — Part-time alongside full-time studies* Paris, France
  - Maintained full financial independence throughout university studies while sustaining a strong academic and research record.
- L1ECO+** Sept. 2023 – Jan. 2024  
*Mathematics and Statistics Tutor* Paris, France
  - Tutored undergraduate students in calculus, probability, and statistics.
  - Supported quantitative reasoning and examination preparation.

## SKILLS AND EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- Languages:** Arabic (native), French (fluent), English (fluent), German (basic knowledge)
- Programming:** Python, R, SQL, VBA
- Econometrics & Causal Inference:** Randomized Controlled Trials (RCT), Instrumental Variables, Difference-in-Differences, Regression Discontinuity, Synthetic Control Methods, panel data models, statistical inference
- Quantitative Analysis:** Empirical economic analysis, data cleaning, econometric modeling, interpretation of causal effects
- Research & Academic Tools:** L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, academic writing, literature review, quantitative reporting
- Office & Data Visualization:** Excel, Word, PowerPoint
- Extracurricular Activities:** Following geopolitical affairs, football, reading in history, sociology, and politics (personal library of 200+ books)